

PEER TO PEER SEARCHES



KaZaA (using the KaZaA Lite K++ client)

KaZaA Lite is a popular P2P client software. Whether it's music, movies, software or even games, chances are you'll find it on the KaZaA network. The best bit is that you can choose to search using Google, or choose instead to perform a P2P search. Take a look at how to make advanced intelligent searches in KaZaA.

Specialise, specialise

Searching KaZaA is fairly easy. If you've chosen P2P searches over Google search, in the main search sidebar on the left, choose from searching for specific binary files such as music, video files, images, or documents. It makes sense to do an 'everything' search only if you can't locate a specific file.

Timing searches

By default, KaZaA Lite searches for only two min-

utes. This can give a huge number of results, or none at all—depending on the criteria, the rarity of the file you're searching for and your connection speed. To increase this time, click on Auto Search More (top-left side-bar). You can choose to search for longer for more results, or do continuous search—as clients keep connecting to the network, you should see more results.

Audio searching

Here's the quickest way to locate the right audio file in KaZaA. First, select P2P search and choose the Audio option. Once done, keep the default 'All' option checked, and enter the artist's name and song. Sift through the multitude of results by clicking on 'More Search Options'. Now, you can choose to refine the search by the 'quality' and 'integrity' ratings to ensure that you get the best download from the lot.

Family filtering

To keep the 'U' rating on your P2P searches, you can set in search filter limits. These can be accessed by clicking on Search Filter on the sidebar, or by going to **Options > Kazaa Lite K++ Options** and flipping across

to the Filters tab. You can set the filter here, and choose from pre-configured modes that filter adult content. Optionally, all such filtering can be password protected. You can also choose to filter suspicious file types, based on file extensions.

DATABASE SEARCHES



Articles and extracts

A good place to start searching for articles online is www.findarticles.com, now owned by LookSmart. FindArticles stores article listings across many genres such as automobiles, art, computers, computing technology, etc., from as far back as 1998.

Searching for articles

The 'Advanced search', accessed from the main page, is limited. However, the site still features listings on many arcane subjects with substantial results. For a narrowed-down list, search from the magazine genre drop-down list to the right.

You can also tweak the search here with searches for

exact phrases, or the presence (or absence), of keywords.

Directory

As you search FindArticles, you can see the directory from which you're receiving the results. To narrow in on a source, inspect the source publications.

Papers online

One of the biggest repositories of papers online is www.itpapers.com. With links to over 25,000 whitepapers on diverse topics, this site can be invaluable as a central listing for research papers. Search here is, unfortunately, limited to plain searches, with little tweaking possible; however the site main page



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